HIA - MVP, Website template and Personas

Minimum valuable product (MVP)

A website with the following features:

- **Document-based knowledge base:** Pull information from a database built from given documents (ESL program details, admissions steps, financial aid and scholarship info, counseling contacts). The PTK research team will provide these documents.
- **Multilingual AI chatbot:** It answers only from the database content. It responds in the user's chosen language, and AI translation is used so answers read in natural language rather than word-for-word. Each answer links to its source document, and the chatbot offers a "talk to a person/Send email" option when it can't answer. The bot should be talking in informative tone and tell the user to send emails in their first language. This helps eliminating the language barrier.
- **Language selection:** Every time a user logs in, ask for their preferred language. The option must also stay visible in the main UI (top bar) so it can be changed at any time.
- **Get connected:** A simple form or button to request contact with a counselor, admissions officer, or peer mentor.

Out of scope for the MVP (later phases):

- Credential-evaluation guidance and childcare resource maps
- Text/WhatsApp access
- Funding plan for the 3-year website maintenance
- **Admin access:** A back end where the PTK/AI club team can upload or update documents without code, so the information stays current.
- **Login credentials:** Basic account creation and login (email or phone). Guest access should also be available, since some users may not want to create an account. The site should collect no immigration status or sensitive information.

Success metrics, log the following data:

- Number of users and languages used.
- Number of counselor connection requests
- User feedback ("Was this helpful?")

Website templates

- **Home:** Language selector at the top, a short welcome message, a prominent chatbot box ("Ask a question in your language"), and 4 large buttons: *Learn English (ESL)*, *Start College*, *Pay for College*, *Talk to Someone*.
- **Chatbot page:** Large chat window, suggested starter questions ("How do I sign up for night ESL classes?"), a "Was this helpful?" button, and a "Connect me with a person" button.
- **ESL & Classes:** Night and weekend program listings, registration steps, and locations.
- **Financial Aid & Scholarships:** Plain-language explanation of aid, the free student pass, and scholarship links.
- **Get Connected:** Counselor/admissions request form, peer mentor info, and PTK representative contact.
- **Login / Sign-up:** Simple form, language prompt on first screen, and a "continue as guest" option.
- **Admin dashboard (internal):** Document upload, content review, and usage stats.

UI principles: Few words per screen, icons next to text, mobile-first (many users will be on phones), high contrast, and navy and gold chapter branding.

Personas

Refugees

- **John:** He has come from Burma with his wife and three children. He's got a job and is doing well but has stopped taking English classes. He would like to know how to take English as a Second Language (ESL) classes but doesn't know where to start, how to register, and just having every resource in English is overwhelming and demotivating for him. It would help John to find the website and ask the chatbot about the current ESL night programs at DC as well as getting connected to a counselor/admissions officer.
- **Amina:** She is a mother of two from Syria who arrived two years ago. She was a pharmacist back home, but her degree isn't recognized in the U.S., and she works part-time while her kids are in school. She wants to go back to school but doesn't know whether her previous education counts for anything, and childcare is her biggest barrier. It would help Amina to ask the chatbot, in Arabic, how previous education is evaluated, what childcare or evening options exist, and to be connected to an advisor.
- **Dawit:** He is 19 and came from Eritrea three years ago with his family. He recently finished high school and assumes college is too expensive since no one in his family has gone. Information about financial aid is confusing and only in English. It would help Dawit to learn about aid, scholarships, and the free student pass in plain language and to be matched with a peer mentor who has a similar background.

Immigrants and people whose first language is not English

- **Maria:** She is a 34-year-old from Mexico who works full-time during the day and cleans offices at night. She speaks some English, but formal documents and websites feel intimidating. She wants to earn a certificate to get a better job, but only weekends work for her schedule. It would help Maria to ask the chatbot, in Spanish, which programs have weekend classes and how to register.
- **Hoa:** She is a 52-year-old from Vietnam and has lived in Dallas for 10 years. She has always relied on her children to translate. She wants to take English classes for herself so she can gain independence, but is embarrassed to ask in person. A private, judgment-free chatbot lets her explore her options at her own pace and in her own language before deciding to contact someone.

Support-side personas

- **Sara, community caseworker:** Works with newly arrived families and needs one link she can share that works in many languages, so she doesn’t have to explain college steps individually.
- **Chris, PTK/AI club admin:** Uploads updated ESL schedules and scholarship deadlines and needs an easy way to keep the database accurate.